

Project 1

Course Code and Name: MSJ1201 Communication Research

Project Name: Research on Millennial

Project Type: Research Proposal

Semester of Submission: Summer 2022

Project Description:

This research studies how well millennial understand and identify false information on social media. It looks at how they check, believe, and share information online. The study will use in-depth interviews with selected millennial. The findings will identify common behaviors and the effects of misinformation on people and society.

Project Justification:

Misinformation and false news are increasing rapidly on social media. Millennial play an important role in consuming and sharing information online. As parents and community members, they can also influence younger generations. This research will identify gaps in their ability to check and recognize false information. The findings can help promote responsible media use and reduce the spread of misinformation.



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UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS
BANGLADESH

Research Proposal

Course Code: *MSJ 1201*

Course Name: *Communication Research*

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1.0 Introduction

1.1 Focus area:

The capacity to fully utilize a variety of media in a responsible, safe, and intelligent manner is known as media and information literacy (MIL). A person can access media, evaluate media material, and use media to take action with the use of a set of competencies called MIL. The ability to comprehend complicated media messages, from newspapers, books, radio, television, billboards, internet, and all other types of media is a trait of those who are media and information literate. (sylvia braesel, 2021) Additionally, to be able to spot false information and verify the truth.

A person born between 1981 and 1996; a member of Generation Y. In 2022, Millennials will range in age from 26-41 years old. (hub, 2022)

The main focus of this research is to find out the media and information literacy among millennials.

1.2 Context:

There are 3 types of false news - misinformation, disinformation, and malinformation.

Misinformation means false information that causes harm. (Security, 2022) Disinformation may appear to be news, but it actually comprises purposeful lies, distortions, and omissions of facts. On social media, disinformation can take the shape of grave falsification, elaborate hoaxes, and amusing fakes that are purposefully taken out of context in order to harm. In both traditional and social media, there are instances of serious fabrication, partial truths, and fraudulent reporting. But in the era of social media, disinformation has exploded. (Security, 2022).

1.3 Reason behind choosing the topic:

The reason behind choosing the topic - The main reason behind choosing the topic is to create awareness among the millennials. As most of the millennials are now parents, their sharing of misinformation can lead to serious havoc. Without clear categorizations or markings, the mixture of true and incorrect material available online can be perplexing, deceiving even the most critical readers and watchers. Children and teenagers may be more susceptible due to misleading information shared by their parents or elders.

1.4 The research objective is as follows:

- Perception among middle-aged people.

1.5 The questions that this research will be answering are:

- What is the common behavior among millennials who are frequently sharing misinformation without verifying the news?
- What is affecting people, due to the spread of false news that is heard and then passed on with some alteration?
- What necessary measures should be taken to recognize misinformation/false news in social media?

1.6 Scopes and Limitations of the Research

1.6.1 Scope:

- It will be possible to know what type of misinformation is being shared by the millennials
- An idea of their media and literacy knowledge can be found.

1.6.2 Limitations:

- Research would be time-consuming to conduct, because of the mass population of millennials.

2.0 Literature review:

The literature review is the portion where the data and guidelines needed for this research project are established and the work's methods are specifically discussed.

2.1 Global research:

2.1.1:

Title: Analysis of Social Media Usage among Millennials

The authors of this research are Rizbi Brandana and Nindyta Aisyah Dwityas. This international journal was published in the year of 2019, and this research is categorized under, "International Journal of English Literature and Social Science."

This study's primary goal is to comprehend how adolescents in South Tangerang use social media and media literacy.

Methodology: With the purpose of sampling technique, data was collected from a thorough questionnaire.

Result: "Individual Competence Framework," which comprises three indicators—media literacy level, communicative abilities—we may estimate the level of media literacy among millennials (Brandana, n.d., #)

2.1.2

Title: The Importance of Millennials Receiving Accurate Information Regarding Social Issues.

This study was concluded by Carol Sutcliffe and Jodi Mari Adams. This journal of education and social sciences was published in 2022.

Objective: the objective is to find out the ability of millennials to distinguish between true and false information, as well as the implications of a lack of factual information.

Methodology: semi-structured interview. Thematic analysis was used to analyze the interviews.

Results: The report urges social media platform designers to take advantage of communication technology to enhance the security and safety of vulnerable users (Sutcliffe, 2022, #).

2.1.3

Title: Exploring Social Media Addiction among Students and Millennials

This research was done by Stacy Grau, Susan Kleiser, and Laura Bright. Journal: Qualitative Market Research: An International Journal. Publication year: 2019.

Objective: Using a theoretical framework, they investigate social media addiction among millennials.

Methodology: A media deprivations methodology with both qualitative and quantitative metrics was employed by the author.

Result: The authors discovered that social media may exist in the "social media addiction" phase based on the consumption continuum ("Exploring Social Media Addiction among Students and Millennials," 2019, #).

2.2 Local Review

2.2.1

Title: Fake News on social media – Who Consume It and Why: Bangladesh Perspective.

The author of this research is Farzana Karim. Journal: Communication and Media in the Asia Pacific.

Objectives: To examine user profiles related to various aspects of social media usage. To uncover the intention and the spread of fake news. To examine the mainstream media treatment of fake news.

Methodology: Study design, data collection, quota sampling method, and data analysis.

Result: Respondent's age, educational level, and family income. The kind of news that users share (Karim., n.d., #).

3.0 Research Design and Method

3.1 Research Methodology

Proposed research approach and data collection method: the study will be using a qualitative approach. The qualitative approach was designed with in-depth interviews as a research method and semi-structured interviews will be taken.

3.2 Sampling

Quota sampling will be the sample technique employed for the investigation. Using the non-probability sampling technique of quota sampling, researchers gather a sample of individuals who fairly represent a population. Researchers select these individuals based on specific qualities or traits. To make sure the market research samples are efficient in gathering data, they make judgments and set quotas. This sampling can be used to estimate the complete population. Only the interviewer's or researcher's understanding of the population will be used to select the final subgroup.

Positive aspects of quota sampling:

Saves time: This sampling procedure is quick and simple because a quota is used to create the samples.

The convenience of research: Quota sampling and appropriate research questions make it much easier for researchers to interpret data and survey responses.

Effectively represents the population of interest: Researchers use this sampling technique to accurately represent a population. As this sampling method enables researchers to analyze the population using defined quotas, there is no possibility of over-representation.

Saves money: Using this sampling technique requires minimal financial investment.

3.3 Time Frame

Category	Time required
Background data collection	7 Days
Literature review	15 Days
Data collection (depends on the method)	60 Days
Data processing and analysis	30 Days
Writing final outcome	10 Days
Total	122 Days

3.4 Budget

Category	Budget required
Resources (Books, Journals, Publications)	7000 Tk
Stationary (Papers, Printing, Pen etc)	3000 TK

Operational Costs (Computer or Laptop, Hard drives, Internet, etc)	90,000tk
Travelling	35,000Tk
Remuneration for data collectors	25,000Tk
Miscellaneous	20,000Tk
Total	1,80,0000 Tk

4.0 Reference List:

- Brandana, R. (n.d.). *Analysis of Social Media Usage Among Millennials. International Journal of English Literature and Social Science.*” 10.22161/ijels.4.2.44
- Exploring Social Media Addiction Among Students and Millennials. (2019). *Qualitative Market Research: An International Journal.*
<https://www.emerald.com/insight/content/doi/10.1108/QMR-02-2017-0058/full/html>
- Karg, T. (2021). *Media and information literacy. Akademie.*
<https://www.dw.com/downloads/56736330/dwa-mil-guidebook-en-3rdedition.pdf>
- Karim., F. (n.d.). *Fake News on social media – Who Consume It and Why: Bangladesh Perspective. Communication and Media in the Asia Pacific.*
<https://so01.tci-thaijo.org/index.php/CMAP/article/download/239963/167807>
- Sutcliffe, C. (2022). *The Importance of Millennials Receiving Accurate Information Regarding Social Issues. journal of education and social sciences,* 20(1).
https://www.jesoc.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/JESOC20_10.pdf

Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- Understand Media and Information Literacy (MIL) and its role in responsible media use.
- Learn to identify misinformation, disinformation, and malinformation and understand their differences.
- Improve information evaluation skills that can be applied to everyday social media use.
- Recognize the importance of responsible information sharing and digital citizenship.
- Understand the social impact of misinformation, particularly its potential influence on families and younger generations.